

ECO-FRIENDLY HEALTHCARE

The Kohinoor Group is setting up a 150-bed multi-speciality hospital in Mumbai, slated to be the first eco-friendly, Platinum LEED certified, green hospital in the country.



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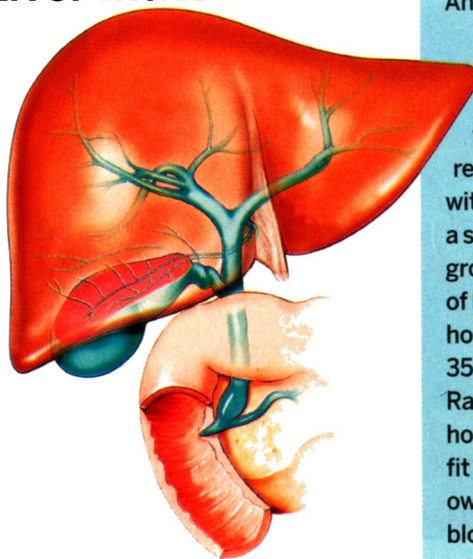
OF HOUSEHOLD
EXPENDITURE IS
SPENT ON HEALTH
CARE IN INDIA.



H1N1 Insurance

Struck by Swine Flu? You can claim hospitalisation expenses under healthcare insurance coverage. Unlike other countries, most health insurance policies in India cover hospitalisation expenses arising out of such epidemics. Health insurance cover, however, becomes applicable only once the person tests positive and is admitted to hospital. Some insurers have already received claims for hospital expenses.

Liver Matchmakers



An 18-month-old Nigerian child and a 44-year-old Mumbai homemaker got united in a till-death-us-do-part bond. Both had terminal liver failure; both were faced with the grim reality of medically fit family donors with incompatible blood groups. But in a stroke of luck, their donors' blood groups matched. Both got a new lease of life by swapping donors in four 16-hour-long simultaneous operations with 35 doctors sweating it out at Sir Ganga Ram Hospital, Delhi. Encouraged, the hospital is now registering patients with fit family donors who do not match their own recipients due to inappropriate blood group or liver size.

Two Great Leaps Forward

St. John's Medical College and Research Institute, Bangalore, is now an 'international centre of excellence' to fight chronic diseases. It received the award from the National Institutes of Health, USA.

The Indian Institute of Technology, Kharagpur, is about to bridge the gap between medicine and engineering. Along with the University of California, San Diego Health Sciences, the institute has committed itself to establish a 300-bed, state-of-the-art medical centre, which will be the first of its kind between a US university and an Indian institution.



It's a Hormone, Actually

Is love finally just a chain of biochemical reactions? Going by the latest studies in *Nature*, it may well be. And all fingers point to the hormone Oxytocin. Released by the thalamus gland, it is believed to act on the brain, the heart and the reproductive system, reducing stress, facilitating bonding, labour and delivery, trust, generosity and sexual pleasure. Internet entrepreneurs are already marketing cologne-like products that apparently provide an added edge by releasing Oxytocin into the air. In the *Nature* essay, Dr Larry Young, a neuroscientist, forecasts Oxytocin's use very soon in marital therapy. The only snag? Oxytocin has to be delivered through a nasal spray.



■ Compiled by Damayanti Datta